



1 November 1993

THE EUROPEAN COMMUNITY BECOMES THE EUROPEAN UNION

The European Economic Community (EEC) became the European Union (EU) when the Maastricht Treaty, signed by its 12 existing member states in February 1992, came into force. The treaty introduced new pillars of co-operation covering security and home affairs, and gave citizens of any one EU country the right to live and work in any other. Passport-free travel and a common currency would follow in future years for states that signed up to them.

<| **Flags of the EU and member states**

1 January 1994 The NAFTA agreement comes into effect, creating a free-trade zone between the US, Canada, and Mexico

11 December 1994 Russian forces enter the breakaway province of Chechnya, starting the First Chechen War

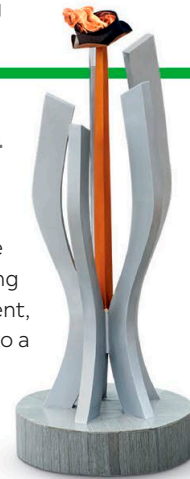
1994

13 September 1993 Israel and the Palestine Liberation Organisation sign up to the first Oslo Accord

THOUSANDS MASSACRED IN RWANDA

The worst genocide since the Holocaust occurred when militias from Rwanda's majority Hutu community turned on the minority Tutsi who had long dominated the country. The killing was triggered by the assassination of the nation's Hutu president, who had earlier negotiated a truce with Tutsi rebels. Up to a million people are thought to have died.

▷ **Memorial to the Rwandan genocide**



1991-1998 THE BALKAN WARS



The socialist state of Yugoslavia was created after World War II as a federation of six republics. Tensions between the groups exploded into conflict.

25 June 1991 Croatia declares independence from Yugoslavia, triggering four years of war with Serbia at a cost of 20,000 dead.

2 April 1992 Sarajevo endures what will be almost four years of siege as civil war breaks out between ethnic groups in Bosnia.

14 December 1995 The Dayton Agreement splits Bosnia-Herzegovina into Serb-dominated and Bosnian-Croat entities.

28 February 1998 War starts in Kosovo between Albanian separatists and the Serb-dominated Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.